

# Founder Approval Checklist

*Platform approvals, compliance obligations and open decisions — founder-owned*

## How to use this checklist

The three requirements documents are written as though every platform approval has already been granted, so your engineers can design without waiting. This checklist is the other half: the approvals, agreements and assessments that only you can obtain, and which will determine when the LMS work can actually ship.

Nothing here blocks architecture or development. It blocks release. Sequence the approval-dependent engineering tasks later in the Phase 2 window accordingly.

**The headline finding.** Google Classroom approval has the longest and least predictable lead time of anything in Phase 2, because Classroom scopes trigger Google's OAuth verification process and potentially a paid third-party security assessment. Start it first, and start it before the code is finished — verification requires a working demonstration, not a finished product.

## 1. Google Classroom

Google Classroom is a REST API integration and a Google Cloud project. Access to Classroom data requires OAuth scopes that Google classifies as sensitive or restricted, which places the application into a formal review process.

### 1.1 What the process involves

- Apps requesting sensitive or restricted scopes must complete Google's OAuth app verification before those scopes are granted for production use across all users.
- For sensitive scopes, Google reviews the OAuth consent screen, the written justification for each scope requested, and a demonstration of the app in use — usually a video walkthrough.
- Restricted scopes go further and can require an independent security assessment carried out by a Google-empanelled assessor, commonly referred to as CASA, resulting in a Letter of Validation.
- Google states the verification process can take several weeks. Where a security assessment is required, plan for considerably longer and for a recurring annual cost.
- Where a security assessment applies, it must be repeated every twelve months to retain access. This is an ongoing operating cost, not a one-off.

**Scope discipline is the lever you control.** The single most effective thing you can do to shorten this is request the narrowest scopes that make the feature work. Establish exactly which Classroom scopes the roster, coursework and grade passback features require, confirm their classification in the Cloud Console before you commit, and drop any scope that is merely convenient. Every unnecessary scope escalates the review tier and the cost.

### 1.2 Checklist

|                          | Item                                                                                                         | Notes                                                                                            |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Create and configure the Google Cloud project and enable the Classroom API                                   | Do this first — scope classification is shown in the Cloud Console.                              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Confirm the exact Classroom scopes required, and their classification (non-sensitive, sensitive, restricted) | Get this from the backend engineer's architecture document. Drop anything not strictly required. |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Verify domain ownership for gradeautomator.com                                                               | Prerequisite for the consent screen.                                                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Complete the OAuth consent screen: app name, logo, support email, developer contact                          | Must exactly match the real, public-facing product.                                              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Publish a privacy policy and terms of service covering Google user data specifically                         | Already live on the site; confirm they meet Google's API Services User Data Policy.              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Write a written justification per scope                                                                      | Prepared with the backend engineer.                                                              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Record the demonstration video showing the full OAuth flow and each scope in use                             | Requires working software — sequence accordingly.                                                |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Submit for OAuth verification                                                                                | Several weeks, per Google.                                                                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Determine whether a CASA security assessment applies                                                         | Depends on final scope classification and how restricted data is stored and transmitted.         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | If required: engage an empanelled assessor, budget for it, and schedule it                                   | Annual recurrence — build it into operating costs.                                               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Assign more than one Google account as Owner or Editor on the Cloud project                                  | Google sends renewal notices there. A single-owner project is a single point of failure.         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Request any needed API quota increases                                                                       | Do this before pilot volume, not during.                                                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Decide whether to list on the Google Workspace Marketplace                                                   | Optional for API access, but relevant for school discoverability and carries its own review.     |

## 2. Canvas and Schoology

**Strategic recommendation — discuss with your backend engineer before committing.** Canvas and Schoology both support LTI 1.3 with LTI Advantage. Names and Role Provisioning Services covers roster retrieval and Assignment and Grade Services covers grade passback — which is most of what Phase 2 needs from both. A single conformant LTI 1.3 Advantage implementation can therefore serve Canvas, Schoology, and most other major LMS platforms, with per-platform work reduced largely to configuration and gradebook line-item mapping. The common and expensive mistake is treating LTI as a per-customer integration. If this holds for your feature set, two custom integrations collapse into one, and every additional LMS afterwards becomes a configuration exercise rather than a project.

### 2.1 What to weigh

- LTI Advantage comprises three services: Deep Linking, Names and Role Provisioning, and Assignment and Grade Services. Certification is offered at Core and at Advantage Complete levels.

- District procurement frequently asks for LTI Advantage certification specifically, rather than bare LTI 1.3 support. Certification runs through 1EdTech and involves membership.
- LTI 1.1 is deprecated and should not be used for anything new.
- The trade-off is that a direct REST API integration can reach platform-specific features that LTI does not expose. Establish with your backend engineer whether anything in Phase 2 actually needs that reach before paying for two integrations.
- There is a per-institution dimension regardless of approach: in practice a school's own LMS administrator installs and authorises the tool in their instance. Your onboarding process needs a documented, repeatable procedure for that conversation.

## 2.2 Checklist

|                          | Item                                                                    | Notes                                                                                    |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Decide LTI 1.3 Advantage versus direct REST integrations                | Requires the backend engineer's recommendation from their architecture document.         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | If LTI: evaluate 1EdTech membership and certification cost and timeline | Certification is what districts ask about by name.                                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Obtain a Canvas developer/test instance                                 | Needed by QA for sandbox testing.                                                        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Obtain a Schoology developer account and test environment               | Same.                                                                                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Establish the Canvas developer key process for pilot institutions       | Typically issued by each institution's own Canvas admin.                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Establish the Schoology app submission and district install path        | Confirm current requirements directly — this process has changed with ownership changes. |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Write the LMS admin onboarding guide for schools                        | You will need this for every pilot district. Write it once.                              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Consider listing in each platform's app directory                       | Discoverability, and a credibility signal for procurement.                               |

## 3. Compliance, contracts and procurement

**This section, not the engineering, is what usually decides whether a district signs.** School districts have standardised procurement questions. A vendor who cannot answer them quickly loses deals to one who can, regardless of product quality. Every item below is something you will be asked for by name.

### 3.1 The AI subprocessor question

This deserves separate attention because it is specific to your architecture and easy to miss. Student work and student identifiers routed through OpenRouter to Grok or GPT means those providers are subprocessors handling student

education records. Many district data privacy agreements restrict or prohibit that without explicit disclosure and contractual coverage.

- Establish and document exactly which fields reach each model provider for each AI feature. Your QA engineer is required to produce this documentation — see QA-CMP-02.
- Confirm the data handling, retention and training-use terms of OpenRouter and each downstream model provider, in writing.
- Decide whether to de-identify student data before it reaches a model provider. If submissions can be graded without a student name attached, that single design decision removes a large category of procurement objection.
- Maintain a public subprocessor list. Districts increasingly require notification of changes, which matters given that your model routing is deliberately dynamic.

### 3.2 Checklist

|                          | Item                                                                         | Notes                                                                                                |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | FERPA-compliant data processing agreement template ready to sign             | You are a school official under FERPA's exception; the agreement must say so correctly.              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | COPPA consent model documented                                               | You rely on school or parental consent via the teacher or admin. Document the chain.                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Review the SDPC National Data Privacy Agreement                              | Many districts will hand you this rather than accept your own paper.                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Check state-specific requirements for your target markets                    | New York Ed Law 2-d, California, Illinois and Texas each add requirements.                           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Consider signing the Student Privacy Pledge                                  | Low cost, and commonly checked.                                                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Complete the AI subprocessor disclosure and obtain provider terms in writing | See 3.1. Do not defer this.                                                                          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Decide the de-identification approach for model calls                        | Architectural — raise with the backend engineer during Phase 2 design, not after.                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Assess SOC 2 Type I or II timing and cost                                    | Increasingly requested at district level; overlaps usefully with CASA evidence.                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Obtain cyber liability and errors-and-omissions insurance                    | Frequently a contractual requirement, not optional.                                                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Produce a VPAT / accessibility conformance report                            | Public-sector procurement asks for this by name. Your QA engineer is scoped to produce the evidence. |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Prepare a standard security questionnaire response pack                      | You will answer the same forty questions repeatedly. Answer them once, well.                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Publish an incident response and breach notification procedure               | Required by most district agreements.                                                                |

## 4. Suggested sequencing

Approval lead times, not engineering effort, should drive the Phase 2 schedule for the LMS epics.

| When                                       | Focus                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Immediately, in parallel with architecture | Google Cloud project setup and scope determination. Canvas and Schoology developer accounts. Begin the LTI versus REST decision with the backend engineer. Open the AI subprocessor terms conversation with OpenRouter. |
| Weeks 1–4                                  | Finalise scopes and submit for Google OAuth verification as soon as a demonstrable flow exists. Determine whether CASA applies and get quotes. Draft the FERPA data processing agreement.                               |
| Weeks 4–12                                 | Work through verification and any security assessment. Meanwhile build and test the non-approval-dependent epics: archiving, copying and shared library, weighting, Units, credits, audit logging and lesson plans.     |
| As approvals land                          | Enable each LMS integration for pilot institutions. Run QA's live sandbox suite against each provider before enabling.                                                                                                  |
| Ongoing                                    | Diarise the annual security assessment renewal and the subprocessor notification obligations. Both are easy to forget and expensive to miss.                                                                            |

## 5. Decisions your engineers are waiting on

These appear as assumptions in the requirements documents. Each has been given a working answer so design can proceed, but each is yours to confirm or overturn. The engineering cost of changing them rises sharply once architecture is signed off.

| Ref | Decision needed                                             | Working assumption                                    |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| A1  | Do students authenticate to LMS platforms in Phase 2?       | No — teacher-scoped tokens only.                      |
| A2  | Who wins when a grade differs between Grade A+ and the LMS? | Neither — the teacher resolves the conflict.          |
| A3  | Must category weights total exactly 100%?                   | Yes, enforced at save.                                |
| A4  | Do archived Sessions freeze their computed averages?        | Yes, snapshotted on archive.                          |
| A5  | Who may publish to the school shared library?               | Licensed teachers submit; School Admin approves.      |
| A6  | May an assignment carry more than one Unit?                 | Yes.                                                  |
| A7  | Do subgroups include protected-class attributes?            | No — teacher-defined cohorts only in Phase 2.         |
| A8  | What is the audit log retention period?                     | 12 months general, 3 years for student-record events. |

| Ref | Decision needed                                                       | Working assumption                                                                                                                    |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| —   | What exactly happens when a teacher runs out of credits?              | Queue or partially complete. Your public FAQ promises work is never blocked or lost, and the implementation must match that sentence. |
| —   | What variance is acceptable when the same submission is graded twice? | Undecided — QA cannot set an accuracy gate without it.                                                                                |
| —   | Should teacher-editable AI feedback be pulled forward into Phase 2?   | Currently deferred. Recommended for reconsideration — see the note in the requirements documents.                                     |